Case Study: Internal Assessment Packet

This Internal Assessment Packet includes two sections:

- Analysis for Vibrant
- Past Performance Citations

Also, draw from the *Vibrant Overview* in the Case Study Overview for additional information.

Competitive Analysis for Vibrant

Customer Perceptions

Strengths	Weaknesses
• CRM developed specifically for recreation/camping stores • Computing Magazine named "Most Stable Application" for the past 5 years • Record of reliable operation—rarely lose an account • Works with support partners (modeled after Apple's support) • Responsive/flexible • Existing Government contracts	• Smaller, niche company • Coding by single partner in India • Fewer employees to draw from • Uncertain how well Vibrant's systems integrate with legacy systems • Difficult to evaluate versus competitor offerings (unique in approach) • Not located near FEMA headquarters

Customer Issues	Available Solution	Discriminator (+/-)	Gap
Innovation and Creativity	Account Executive (AE) functions as client's internal expert consultant "Service is a delight to both clients and potential employees"	+ Sited with the client + Flexible	None
International Experience	Global specialty equipment supply experience CRM systems were built and proven effective in global outdoor equipment industry segment	+ Standard for CRM in Singapore, Europe, and Malaysia; 500+ sites, 12 countries + Industry segment & cultural understanding	Limited experience in Africa and India
CRM Features	OSG can either maintain/expand current centers or outsource to a Vibrant partner company Designed for relevant tasks; new features are incorporated as identified; client selects which to use	+ Flexibility + Focused on industry already + Potential employee morale booster	Variable solution features require more testing before go-live

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Customer Issues	Available Solution	Discriminator (+/-)	Gap
Transition	Assigned onsite team leads transition High level executive support for transition "Transformational" improvements addressed during transition for early wins	+ Seamless transfer from transition to operation + Executive involvement + Early wins: cost savings, service improvements + Eliminates handoff from Transition Manager others	Fit with FEMA culture
Project Management	Innovative, empowered, collaborative project team Robust governance model is easy to understand and adapt Clear Corporate Authority Matrix Aligned approach fosters continuous improvement Public sector experience	+ Long term, onsite account management + Clear corporate delegated authority commensurate with responsibility + Aligns with innovative goals	Could be perceived as less structured
Pricing	Complex: Per-transaction by volume; per hour for specific services; fixed-price components; and positive/negative incentives.	– Difficult to evaluate vs. competitive offerings	Maintaining current service centers may be more expensive than outsource
New Market Penetration (i.e. Government)	Use CRM to support equipment tracking and invoice/vendor management Successful public sector implementations	– Some exposure in the government space + Interest derived from foreign governments' response to outdoor retailer uses + Customer/end user tracking to predict needs/wants and timeline	CRM used to track and anticipate needs

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Past Performance Citation 1: Western Mountain Specialties (WMS)

Twelve years ago, Western Mountain Specialties (WMS), a specialty high-adventure equipment and supply company, expanded its U.S. network north into Canada and east to Europe, increasing sales and distribution locations to 650. WMS had gained a following by sponsoring several specialty equipment expos and exhibitions for the past three seasons in these countries, while also demonstrating their wares at these events. WMS sought to track customers and vendors and their preferences in these regions and solicited external support to help manage the customer base. Vibrant won the first contract based on our extensive dealings with the European outdoor specialty community.

Vibrant helped WMS achieve 18 percent annual market growth in their targeted areas, increase revenue through online and digital marketing channels by 75 percent (100 million USD), and increase outreach campaign participation by 12 percent.

Last year, WMS extended Vibrant's support for 5 more years, without requiring a re-compete. Based on our recommendations that they improved their e-business efforts to maintain their market share, WMS sought to heighten the "stickiness" of their customer base by implementing enhanced CRM support for their field office personnel. WMS selected Vibrant due to our industry understanding, collaborative spirit, and willingness to listen and adapt.

"After 5 consecutive years of steady double-digit sales growth, we opted to extend our Vibrant CRM support relationship on advantageous terms without the need for a time-consuming open competition."
—WMS COO, Nelson Hanes

Lessons Learned

As part of our lessons learned from this effort, we documented the following key lessons:

- Beware of international currency rates when citing potential cost improvements.
- Involve in-country business personnel to help effectively target end-user preferences by culture.
- For highly tailored requirements, conduct due diligence on these activities as seen from within the company and from knowledgeable observers and customers outside the company.

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Past Performance Citation 2: U.S. Air Force

The U.S. Air Force (USAF) provides its personnel and their families all types of sports, arts, recreation, libraries, and other morale strengthening services across the world. The USAF Morale, Welfare, and Recreation program (MWR) requires a multitude of vendors and suppliers to provide specialty supplies and equipment. Each USAF base location also requires careful tracking and monitor of the recreation, arts, and educational supplies and government assets. To maintain morale and honor its commitment to personnel and their families, the USAF sought to upgrade its IT systems to better serve personnel and field officers who manage the program.

The USAF MWR conducted careful research and secure budget for a new system with CRM-like functions as part of the technology upgrade. A formal solicitation was developed and distributed, and a bidders' conference was held at the Air Force Academy in Colorado Springs.

Vibrant had previously responded to a request for information and was requested to submit a bid for a CRM system. Last year, Vibrant was down-selected and then awarded a 3-year contract with 3 potential extension years. The deliverable was a global CRM system to help track and monitor all MWR supplies and vendors, including a system to monitor end-user and USAF personnel satisfaction. The system is fully functional at 23 USAF locations around the world. Feedback from USAF shows a satisfaction rate for specialty product delivery and software usability at 97.3 percent, a 65 percent improvement from previous satisfaction surveys referencing legacy systems. They have reduced their vendors by 33 percent, creating significant efficiency gains.

Lessons Learned

- Carefully understand the needs and requirements of end users at various field locations
- Understand government customer's vision and mission. Know who their stakeholders are and all decision drives to align solutions with needs.
- Acknowledge the value of current and legacy systems and work toward building a coalition of internal stakeholders that will champion the new solution.

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